

July 17th, 2026
Week 29
Volume 282, Issue 1244

QUOTE
of the
WEEK

"The best way out is always through."

- Robert Frost

Highlights:

- Blockade returns.

- Brent climbs.

- Flood toll rises.

- Yards stall.

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-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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BLOCKADE RETURNS, TOLL RISES

The second act arrived with a name this time, and it was not "ceasefire." Five consecutive days of American strikes through Wednesday hit Iranian positions from Bandar Abbas and Qeshm Island to Sirik, while Washington reinstated the naval blockade of Iranian ports lifted during June's interim peace. The blockade found its first target within a day. A Curaçao-flagged tanker bound for Kharg Island ignored repeated warnings and was disabled by a Hellfire strike into its smokestack, stopping the vessel without spilling its cargo. Two others were redirected without incident. President Trump is reportedly weighing a broader campaign and has revived the idea of seizing Kharg Island outright, while abandoning the proposed 20% Hormuz transit fee. Nobody involved is using the word peace this week, which may be the most accurate statement anyone has made since February.

Oil has now made this climb three times since the conflict opened, and the muscle memory shows. Brent touched USD 84.77 and WTI USD 79.56 on Thursday, one-month highs that recovered roughly one-third of the ground surrendered during June's interim peace. A reinstated blockade and open discussion of taking a major export terminal will do that. Yet the move remains smaller than the first shock, and the market's patience is noticeably shorter. Traders are repricing a war whose script they can now recite from memory.

Freight, characteristically, is having a different week. The Baltic Dry Index closed Friday at 2,944, its highest since June 5, while the Capesize Index rose 1.9% to 4,655 on continued iron ore and coal demand. Dry bulk owners are pricing cargo fundamentals rather than Hormuz, and for another week, cargo fundamentals are winning the argument. The recycling implication remains familiar. Firmer earnings keep ageing tonnage trading, while renewed war risk interrupts the Gulf exit queue.

The data released this week was arguing with the news that overtook it. U.S. June inflation eased to 3.5% from 4.2%, its first decline in five months, with core inflation slowing to 2.6% as the energy relief delivered by the now-defunct ceasefire reached the figures. India's June print moved the other way, rising to 4.38% from 3.93%, its highest since December 2024 and above expectations as the spring energy shock reached transport and food costs. The calm print anticipated last week did not arrive, and the Rupee noticed. USD/INR touched 96.40 on Thursday before easing toward 96.20. The Taka held near 123.30, the Turkish Lira reached another record near 47.10, and the Pakistani Rupee barely moved, the only basin currency that appears to have opted out of 2026. In Bangladesh, the numbers that matter most are not economic. Flooding and landslides across Chattogram, Cox's Bazar, Habiganj, and neighbouring districts have killed at least 51 people and affected more than one million. A failed embankment on the Khowai River flooded twenty-five villages, while a landslide inside a Cox's Bazar refugee camp killed sixteen Rohingya residents, including children. Against that human toll, disruption to Chattogram's yards is secondary, but commercially real. Beaching has slowed to a near-halt for a second consecutive week, and the Gulf exit queue that was expected to test the port's capacity this month now waits on a recovery that has not arrived.

The war has returned to the strait just as the weather has closed the beach. Firmer freight keeps candidates trading, the blockade delays the Gulf exit queue, and flooding prevents Chattogram from absorbing whatever reaches it. The market remains paused, not broken. The ships wait for passage. The yards wait for dry land.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 29 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

**FLOODS DEEPEN, MARKET WAITS**

The toll.

The confirmed death toll from this month's flooding and landslides has reached at least 51, with 39 injured and more than one million people affected across seven districts, according to disaster-management officials. An embankment failure on the Khowai River flooded twenty-five villages in Habiganj, while a landslide inside a Rohingya refugee camp in Cox's Bazar killed sixteen residents, including children. The Chattogram Meteorological Office has recorded some of the heaviest rainfall totals in the region's history over the past ten days, and forecasters continue to monitor several river basins for renewed short-term flooding. Prime Minister Tarique Rahman has ordered all relevant agencies onto maximum alert, while emergency cash and rice allocations have been released to the worst-affected districts.

Markets pause.

Against that human toll, the commercial picture remains what it has been for two weeks: paused, not broken. Beaching activity at Chattogram has slowed to a near-halt, cash-buyer enquiries remain thin, and the July 14 to 17 tide window closes with little to show for it. The next window with meaningful capacity opens July 29. Yards that had positioned for the deferred Gulf exit wave are, for now, waiting for dry ground, while the renewed blockade and firmer freight market give owners further reason to delay recycling decisions. The supply has not disappeared. Its arrival has simply been deferred again.

Reserves hold.

The macro backdrop continues to run separately from both the weather and the war. USD/BDT held near 123.30, comfortably within the range established after Week 27's break, with reserves supported by the IMF's confirmed USD 1.3 billion disbursement following June's reform breakthrough. No new inflation print is due until early August, leaving June's 9.16% as the operative read. The fiscal year closed with average inflation near 8.68%, above the government's 7% target, but below the double-digit pressures seen elsewhere in the basin. Local steel trading remains effectively suspended, with no reliable fresh price direction emerging from mills or yards. The plot floor is, for the moment, underwater in more ways than one.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



THE CALM THAT WASN'T

USD/INR touched 96.40 on Thursday, its weakest level since May and within striking distance of the May 21 record of approximately 96.97, before a modest Friday recovery returned it toward 96.20. The Reserve Bank was again visible smoothing the move through state-run banks, though Governor Malhotra has consistently described such action as volatility management rather than defence of a particular level. The ten-year yield and equity markets both moved through a milder version of the Week 28 shock, suggesting that the second escalation has rattled fewer nerves than the first, even at a weaker exchange rate.

Rupee climbs.

Last week's edition previewed India's June CPI as a reading struck largely during the peace-era oil window that "should still print calm." It did not. Inflation rose to 4.38% from 3.93%, its highest since December 2024 and above every forecast on the board. Transport inflation rebounded to 4.31% as the spring energy shock cleared customs, while food inflation rose to 5.32%, helped by a 50% surge in ginger prices. The lesson is familiar: forecasting Indian inflation during a conflict that repeatedly stops and starts remains a dangerous game. July's number, due next month, now has considerably more to explain.

The calm wasn't.

Local steel plate at Alang firmed through the week from approximately INR 37,200 to INR 38,000, with the USD equivalent rising toward USD 394 as the local increase outweighed the weaker Rupee. The July 11 to 20 tide window enters its final days with the Gulf exit queue still suspended and monsoon conditions limiting beaching activity. Alang's wider position remains unchanged for a third consecutive week: the basin's deepest capacity, more than 115 valid Statements of Compliance, the strongest compliance profile, the weakest price, and little tonnage being offered.

Alang holds.

PAKISTAN



RUPEE HOLDS, BLOCKADE BITES

Blockade bites.

The reinstated U.S. naval blockade produced its first casualty within a day, with a tanker bound for Kharg Island disabled by Hellfire fire after ignoring repeated warnings and two further vessels redirected without incident. The enforcement sits closer to Gadani's routing lanes than anything since April's original blockade, reviving the locational calculus that briefly favoured Pakistan earlier this year. Brokers report renewed war-risk premiums for Gulf-transiting recycling candidates, though from a sufficiently low base that the increase is more notable than the absolute level.

Rupee unbothered.

USD/PKR spent the week inside a range of barely a quarter rupee, closing near 278.15 and remaining effectively unchanged through renewed conflict, a disabled tanker, and another round of American strikes. For the third escalation this year, the Pakistani Rupee remains the only basin currency that has simply declined to react. The State Bank's 11.5% policy rate and disciplined reserve management continue to receive the credit, though the currency's stability is beginning to look less like a policy outcome and more like a defining characteristic. No new CPI print is due until early August, leaving June's 11.1% reading and rare outright monthly decline as the operative verdict.

Duties unchanged.

Gadani's plate quote held flat at PKR 195,000 per ton, near USD 700, for a second consecutive week, while the July 1 Regulatory Duty relief continues working through the market at its own pace. Yard demand remains steady but unspectacular. Pakistan closed Week 28 asking whether locational advantage or owner hesitation would dominate as the conflict resumed. One week later, the answer remains unchanged: the market has not finished deciding, and may not do so before the next headline arrives.

TURKEY

STILL HELD, STILL DISPUTED



The TCMB kept its policy rate at 37% at its latest meeting, the third consecutive hold, citing renewed energy-price volatility in the inflation outlook. The committee's language was unchanged, with rates set to remain restrictive until price stability is achieved. USD/TRY nevertheless moved into fresh record territory near 47.10, while the effective overnight rate near 40% continues to carry the policy burden without yet reversing the currency's decline.

Rate held, third time.

June's official inflation reading of 32.11%, the lowest since March, remains the headline figure. Independent economists at the Inflation Research Group place the annual rate closer to 51.4%, a gap that has persisted for years and shows no sign of narrowing. Both measures agree on the direction, if not the scale. June benefited from easing oil prices. July is being struck against a renewed conflict and another rise in crude, making a repeat of that relief less likely.

The other number.

Aliaga's plate indications held at USD 263 to USD 285 per LDT across vessel types, leaving Turkey structurally uncompetitive against the sub-continent for a third consecutive week. The eventual routing of the Gulf exit queue remains secondary to Aliaga's core market. Turkey's share continues to be defined by EU regulation, Basel Convention compliance, and specialist tonnage rather than price. The war has changed the headlines. It has not changed the niche.

Niche unmoved.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 29 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	Softening	448-453 / LDT	468-473 / LDT	478-483 / LDT
2	Pakistan	Steady	443-448 / LDT	463-468 / LDT	473-478 / LDT
3	India	Steady	418-423 / LDT	438-443 / LDT	448-453 / LDT
4	Turkey	Softening	263-265 / LDT	273-275 / LDT	283-285 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *Recycling vessels at Alang is estimated to have saved **124.5 million barrels of oil**, equivalent to approximately **19.8 billion litres**.*
- *Alang's vessel-recycling output is estimated to have avoided emissions comparable to the annual output of approximately **9 coal-fired power plants**.*
- *The recovery and reuse of ship steel at Alang is estimated to have saved **44.4 billion kWh of energy**, equal to around **37 million household-years of electricity use**.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
August 15 – Independence Day	July 11 – July 20 July 27 – August 04

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
August 05 - July Uprising Day August 26 - Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	July 29 – August 01 August 12 – August 15

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
August 14 – Independence Day August 25 – Eid Milad-un-Nabi	August 30 – Victory Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of July 17, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Frio Antarctic	5,700	General Cargo	<i>Delivered July 17</i>
2	Valiant Roar	4,155	Oil Tanker	<i>Delivered July 15</i>
3	Seabass	9,079	Oil Tanker	<i>Delivered July 13</i>
4	Bato	3,922	Fishing	<i>Delivered July 11</i>
5	Seaturbo	9,080	Oil Tanker	<i>Delivered July 11</i>
6	Stolt Sypress	11,452	Chemical Tanker	<i>Delivered July 11</i>
7	Gautam	780	Supply	<i>Arrived July 04</i>

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of July 17, 2026

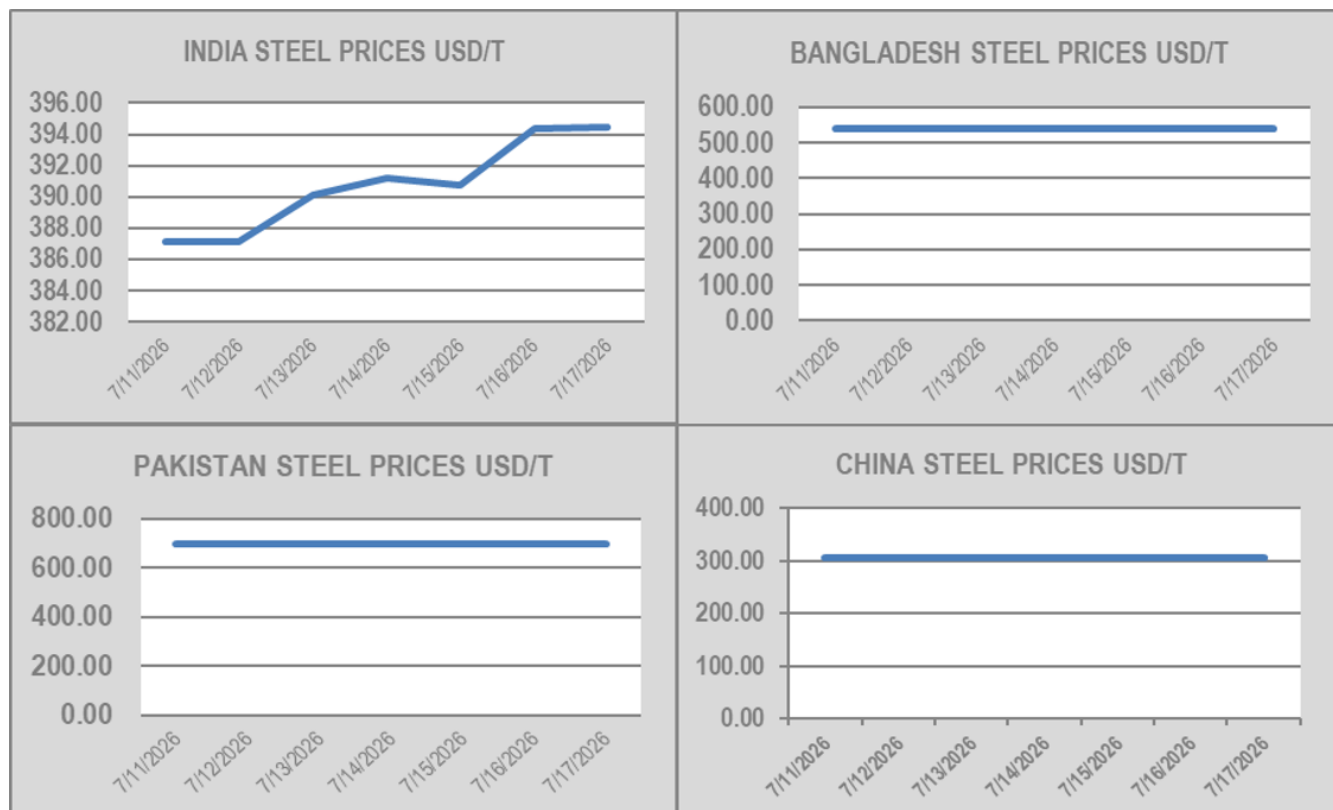
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Tai Shuen	2,990	Tanker	<i>Arrived July 16</i>
2	Meili	903	Multipurpose Cargo	<i>Delivered July 15</i>
3	Bulan	5,469	Bulk Carrier	<i>Arrived July 14</i>

GADANI - Port Position as of July 17, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Ila	6,334	Bulk Carrier	<i>Arrived July 04</i>

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
7/11/2026	387.12	36,900.00	696.43	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	306.32
7/12/2026	387.12	36,900.00	696.43	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	306.32
7/13/2026	390.09	37,300.00	696.43	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	306.32
7/14/2026	391.18	37,600.00	696.43	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	306.32
7/15/2026	390.77	37,600.00	696.43	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	306.32
7/16/2026	394.40	38,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	306.32
7/17/2026	394.44	38,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	306.32



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